

What does Copilot Cowork actually cost?

Delegated work, made simple — priced in cups of coffee

Copilot Cowork is the agentic side of Microsoft 365 Copilot. You describe the outcome and it does the whole task end-to-end — drafting the document, building the deck, pulling the data, sending the email — working in the cloud even when your laptop is off. Here’s how it’s priced, in plain English.

Your bill has two parts

1 · Your Copilot seat (fixed)

A Microsoft 365 Copilot licence for each user — the entry ticket.

Predictable, per user each month.

Includes Copilot Chat, Copilot in Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook & Teams, and Work IQ.

Like a monthly coffee-shop membership.

2 · Cowork usage (flexes)

You pay for the actual work Cowork does, measured in **Copilot Credits**.

Flexes with how much you hand over to it.

Pay-as-you-go, or prepay (P3) for a discount.

Like paying for each coffee you order.

The coffee test

A whole Cowork task costs about the price of a coffee.

One coffee = \$3.50 ≈ 350 credits. The bigger the job, the bigger the order.



Task size	What it looks like	Credits	≈ Cost	In coffees
Light the flat white	A quick Monday status update from a few sources	100–300	\$1–\$3	up to ~1
Medium coffee & cake	A meeting-prep doc + Excel + slide from many sources	400–700	\$4–\$7	1–2
Heavy a coffee round	Classify 6 months of data into a leadership report	700+	\$7+	2+

Credit ranges are Microsoft’s own illustrative estimates from the Cowork launch — actual cost varies by task.

What makes a task cost more?

Models The AI model it uses — smarter models cost more	Context How much of your email, files & meetings it reads	Tools Actions it takes — send, schedule, update	Runtime How long it keeps working in the cloud
--	---	---	--

A day in the life

A manager who delegates **one light + one medium task a day** uses ~750 credits — about **\$7.50, or two coffees a day**. Over a month that’s roughly **\$150 per person**; a team of ten, around **\$1,500 a month** — for work that would otherwise take hours of effort.

Two ways to pay

	Pay-as-you-go	Prepaid (P3)
How it works	Pay per credit, billed monthly	Commit to a volume up front
The rate	\$0.01 per credit	Discounted vs pay-as-you-go
Best when	Trying it out / variable use	Predictable, higher volume

Good to know

- **It's off by default.** Your IT admin switches Cowork on and chooses who gets access.
- **You stay in control.** Admins set spending limits and alerts at tenant, group and user level.
- **Costs are visible.** You can see what each task costs, so spend never sneaks up on you.
- **A Copilot licence comes first.** Cowork sits on top of Microsoft 365 Copilot.

The fine print: Figures are indicative and for illustration only. They use Microsoft's list pay-as-you-go rate of about \$0.01 per credit (shown as ~1¢) and a \$3.50 coffee. The light/medium/heavy credit ranges are Microsoft's own launch estimates, based on a frontier model (Anthropic Opus 4.8); a lighter model — such as Microsoft's upcoming Cowork 1 — is designed to cost less. Your actual cost depends on the tasks you run, the model chosen and your agreement.